MODULE 5

Module 5: Equipment Care

4 techniques · 12 video lessons



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1. Clipper cleaning and oiling

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Next step

> *Your tools are your livelihood and your clients' safety. A clipper that is clean, oiled and sharp cuts evenly, runs cooler and lasts years longer. A station that is properly disinfected protects every person who sits in your chair. This module shows you how to maintain both.*

Why equipment care matters

Poorly maintained equipment pulls hair, overheats, leaves lines in fades and can irritate skin. Dirty tools can also spread bacteria and fungus between clients. Good habits cost minutes per day and save you money, time and reputation.

The daily, weekly and monthly rhythm

WHEN	WHAT TO DO
After every client	Brush off hair, wipe handles and surfaces, disinfect blades and combs that touched the client
End of day	Deep clean blades, oil the clippers, empty and disinfect the station
Weekly	Check blade alignment, inspect cords and guards, clean hair from vents
Monthly	Inspect for wear, replace worn parts, review your maintenance log

Cleaning versus disinfecting

These are different steps. **Cleaning** physically removes hair, oil and debris. **Disinfecting** uses an appropriate disinfectant, applied for the contact time stated on its label, to kill pathogens on a clean surface. You must clean first, because disinfectant cannot work through dirt.

> **Follow the label and local rules**
>
> Use disinfectants that are approved for barbering use in your area and follow the manufacturer's contact time and dilution exactly. Regulations for sanitation vary by location, so check your local licensing and health requirements.

What this module covers

1. Clipper cleaning and oiling: the routine that keeps blades cool and sharp.
2. Changing the ceramic blade: safe removal, fitting and alignment.
3. Scissor and razor care: protecting edges and handling single-use blades.
4. Disinfecting tools and the station: the protocol that protects clients.

Tools you will need

- Cleaning brush with stiff bristles

- Clipper oil designed for blades
- Screwdriver that fits your clipper
- Disinfectant approved for barbering tools
- Clean lint-free cloths
- Sharps container for used razor blades
- Gloves

Always check your clipper's manual for model-specific instructions. This module uses general descriptions and avoids trademarked tool names. Where your manual and this course differ, follow your manual.

> **Unplug first**
> Before opening, adjusting or cleaning any corded or cordless clipper, switch it off and unplug or remove the battery. Never put electrical tools in water.

> **About the video lessons**
> This module lists 12 curated public video lessons from experienced barbers, linked from their original channels. They belong to their creators and links can change over time. Every technique also has complete written steps, so you can follow it without the videos.

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1. Clipper cleaning and oiling

> *Keep blades free of hair and debris and properly lubricated so the clipper runs cool, quiet and sharp.*

Estimated practice time: 5-10 minutes

Tools you need

- Cleaning brush
- Blade oil made for clippers
- Lint-free cloth
- Screwdriver if required
- Clipper disinfectant spray approved for blades

- Gloves

Step by step

1. Switch the clipper off, unplug it or remove the battery, and place it on a clean towel.
2. Brush hair away from the blade teeth and the blade edges. Use the brush in short strokes away from your body.
3. If your manual allows it, remove the blade by following the manufacturer's steps and brush the housing and drive area.
4. Apply a disinfectant spray approved for blades and follow its label for contact time. Do not soak the clipper body.
5. Wipe off disinfectant and residue with a clean cloth once the contact time has passed.
6. Refit the blade as the manual directs, making sure it sits securely and is not crooked.
7. Turn the clipper on and apply a very small amount of blade oil along the top of the blade teeth, spread across the width.
8. Run the clipper for several seconds so oil spreads between the blades, then wipe excess oil with a cloth.
9. Store the clipper in a clean, dry spot with the blade guard on, away from moisture.
10. Log the date of each deep clean so you notice if maintenance is slipping.

Common mistakes

- Oiling a dirty blade, which turns hair and oil into sludge.
- Using too much oil so it drips onto skin.
- Using cooking or household oils instead of blade oil.
- Soaking clippers in liquid.
- Brushing hair back into the housing.

Practice drill

Time yourself doing a full clean-and-oil cycle. Repeat daily for a week and aim to reach a consistent routine under five minutes.

> **Safety note**
>
> Always unplug before cleaning. Do not spray disinfectant directly onto electrical parts, and never submerge an electrical tool.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
HOW TO CLEAN & OIL YOUR CLIPPERS FOR PEAK PERFORMANCE https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TolRP7o0lig	Barber Style Directory	Cleaning and oiling clippers for peak performance
Clipper Maintenance 101 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k0fBIe8qS3c	Wahlpro	Professional clipper maintenance basics
Clipper Oiling https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3qJAiHtnnDk	Wahl Australia & New Zealand	How and where to oil clipper blades

2. Changing the ceramic blade

> *Remove, replace and align a ceramic blade correctly so cuts stay even and skin stays safe.*

Estimated practice time: 10-15 minutes

Tools you need

- Replacement blade compatible with your clipper
- Screwdriver that fits the screws
- Cleaning brush
- Blade oil
- Lint-free cloth
- Small tray for screws

Step by step

1. Unplug the clipper or remove its battery. Place a towel on the work surface.
2. Check the manual to see how your blade attaches. Some snap on and some use screws.
3. Remove screws or release clips in the order the manufacturer shows and keep them in a tray.
4. Slide off the old blade and inspect for cracks, chips or bent teeth. Replace if damaged.
5. Brush the housing and drive arm to remove hair and old oil before fitting the new blade.
6. Position the new blade so the teeth are parallel with the blade edge and correctly seated against the drive arm.
7. Tighten the screws evenly, a little at a time, without forcing them.
8. Check alignment: the cutting blade should sit slightly behind the guard blade as shown in the manual. Adjust per the instructions if needed.
9. Apply a small amount of blade oil, switch the clipper on and listen. It should run smoothly without rattling.
10. Test on a scrap of hair or a practice head before using it on a client.

Common mistakes

- Over-tightening and cracking the blade.
- Fitting the blade crooked.
- Using a blade that is not made for your clipper model.
- Forgetting to oil afterward.
- Skipping the test run.

Practice drill

Practice removing and refitting a blade three times on your own clipper, following the manual, until you can do it without hesitation.

> **Safety note**
>
> Unplug first and handle ceramic blades with care. They can chip and the edges are sharp. Dispose of damaged blades safely.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
How to change the blades and zero gap on the TPOB, GO CLIPPER @THEPISSEDOFFBARBER https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sUHPWjIo-V0	Richie Van Buren	Changing clipper blades and zero gapping, demonstrated
Andis Q&A: How to Attach and Detach a Blade https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=T-F-NSUgms0	D&B Supply	Attaching and detaching a clipper blade safely
HOW TO | CHANGING OUT WAHL BALDING BLADE | PLUS ZERO GAPPING! | SOUTH AFRICA https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Qj3-mBFtUio	JNRUSS4	Swapping a blade and aligning it with zero gapping

3. Scissor and razor care

> *Protect cutting edges, keep them hygienic and handle single-use razor blades safely.*

Estimated practice time: 10 minutes

Tools you need

- Shears or scissors
- Soft cloth
- Scissor oil
- Disinfectant approved for shears
- Razor handle for single-use blades
- Sharps container

- Gloves

Step by step

1. After each client, wipe the shears with a soft cloth to remove hair and product.
2. Disinfect the blades and handles following the label's contact time, using a method that does not damage the edges.
3. Open the shears fully and apply a tiny drop of scissor oil at the pivot. Open and close a few times and wipe off excess.
4. Never use shears on anything other than hair, since paper or wire damages the edge.
5. Store shears in a case or pouch so the tips do not knock against other tools.
6. For razors that use single-use blades, open a fresh blade for every client and show it is new if appropriate.
7. After the service, remove the used blade carefully with tweezers or the safe method for your holder and drop it straight into a sharps container.
8. Disinfect the razor handle and clean the work area.
9. Have shears professionally checked and sharpened when you feel pulling or hear a rough sound.

Common mistakes

- Dropping shears and bending the tips.
- Reusing a single-use blade.
- Throwing used blades in a regular trash bin.
- Over-oiling, which attracts hair.
- Leaving wet shears to rust.

Practice drill

Practice a full shears care cycle: wipe, disinfect, oil, dry, store. Do it after every practice session for a week.

> **Safety note**
>
> Razor blades are sharp. Always wear gloves when handling used blades, never leave them loose and dispose of them in a puncture-resistant sharps container as your local rules require.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Basic Scissor Maintenance https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IdpE-Y0aayQ	Ross Simms	Basic scissor maintenance for hairdressers
How to Clean and Oil Hair Shears https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nUS_yWmknD8	Mag Shears	Cleaning and oiling hair shears

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Straight Razor Care: Simple Tips for Long Life https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6R9sXchLhmU	RazorEmporium	Straight razor care tips for long blade life

4. Disinfecting tools and the station

> *Run a consistent protocol that cleans and disinfects tools, surfaces and your hands between clients.*

Estimated practice time: 5-10 minutes between clients

Tools you need

- Disinfectant approved for barbering use
- Clean towels and cloths
- Hand soap and sanitizer
- Disinfecting container for combs and brushes
- Gloves
- Covered trash can
- Sharps container

Step by step

1. Wash your hands with soap and water before and after every client, and use sanitizer between services as needed.
2. Use a fresh, clean cape and neck strip for each client. Launder used capes and towels before reuse.
3. Remove hair from combs, brushes and clipper guards with a brush or by rinsing in soap and water.
4. Clean first: wash tools with soap and water so the disinfectant can work effectively.
5. Immerse non-electrical tools in an approved disinfectant for the contact time on the label. Prepare fresh solution as the manufacturer requires.
6. Wipe the chair, counter, handles and any touched surfaces with disinfectant and let them stay wet for the stated contact time.
7. Dispose of used neck strips, paper and single-use items in a covered trash can.
8. Sweep hair after each client and keep the floor free of clippings to avoid slips.
9. If a client is accidentally cut, put on gloves, apply pressure with clean gauze, clean the area and cover it with a bandage. Dispose of contaminated items safely and disinfect tools and surfaces before continuing.
10. End of day: empty containers, replace solutions, launder linens and write down that the cleaning was done.

Common mistakes

- Skipping the cleaning step before disinfecting.

- Using disinfectant for less than the stated contact time.
- Using expired or diluted solution.
- Reusing capes and neck strips between clients.
- Forgetting hand hygiene.

Practice drill

Write a one-page station checklist and follow it for five practice sessions. Time how long each between-client reset takes and refine the checklist.

> **Safety note**
>
> Follow the disinfectant's label and local health regulations. Wear gloves when handling contaminated items and never use a tool that has touched blood until it has been cleaned and disinfected properly.

Curated video lessons

VIDEO LESSON	CHANNEL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Barber Sanitation Routine | How I Disinfect My Tools https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=makALZn-FXg	Vousman Barber	A barber's full tool disinfection routine
How to Clean Barber Tools | Avoid Spreading Infection and Outbreaks https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uMtNG2v08VA	Barber Style Directory	Cleaning barber tools to avoid spreading infection
Learn how to sanitize your barber tools! https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vn-I7wsOwGg	YOUTUBE BARBER ACADEMY	Sanitizing barber tools correctly

Next step

Practice each technique on a mannequin head until you can repeat it with clean results, then move to the next module.